Leaf Coaching

STAFF PROCEDURE
WEBSITE & JOURNAL

TEA STORIES · STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Adding a *tea story.*

A plain-English guide to writing, publishing and caring for stories on the Leaf Coaching website — from signing in to checking the live page.

STAFF ENTRANCE

www.leafcoaching.com/admin/login

Bookmark this page. Staff password required.

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OWNER: LEAF COACHING WEBSITE

START HERE

The short version.

Tea Stories are managed from a private staff area. You can write a story, save it as a draft, publish it, edit it later, or take it down — all from the same story desk.

STAFF LOGIN

www.leafcoaching.com/admin/login

Sign in with the shared staff password.

PUBLIC JOURNAL

www.leafcoaching.com/tea-stories

This is where published stories appear. The newest story by story date is featured first.

READ THIS BEFORE YOUR FIRST STORY

Publishing is switched on by default for a new story. If the story is not ready to appear publicly, untick **Published** before you click **Create story**. The label changes to **Save as a draft**, and only signed-in staff will see it.

The workflow at a glance

ABOUT 10–20 MINUTES

1
Sign in
Open the staff login and enter the shared password.

2
Start a story
From the story desk, click **New tea story**.

3
Add a cover
Choose a warm landscape photograph for the story.

4
Write
Add a title, optional introduction, and the story itself.

5
Choose status
Keep **Published** ticked, or untick it for a draft.

6
Create & check
Click **Create story**, then **View** to check the live page.

Have these ready

- [ ] The shared staff password.
- [ ] A landscape cover image: JPG, PNG, WebP or AVIF, ideally at least 1200px wide.
- [ ] A title and the story text — ideally saved somewhere safe as well.
- [ ] An optional one- or two-sentence introduction.

Good to know

There is no auto-save. Keep a copy of longer writing until you have clicked **Create story** or **Save changes**.

A published story goes live as soon as you save. A draft is not visible to the public.

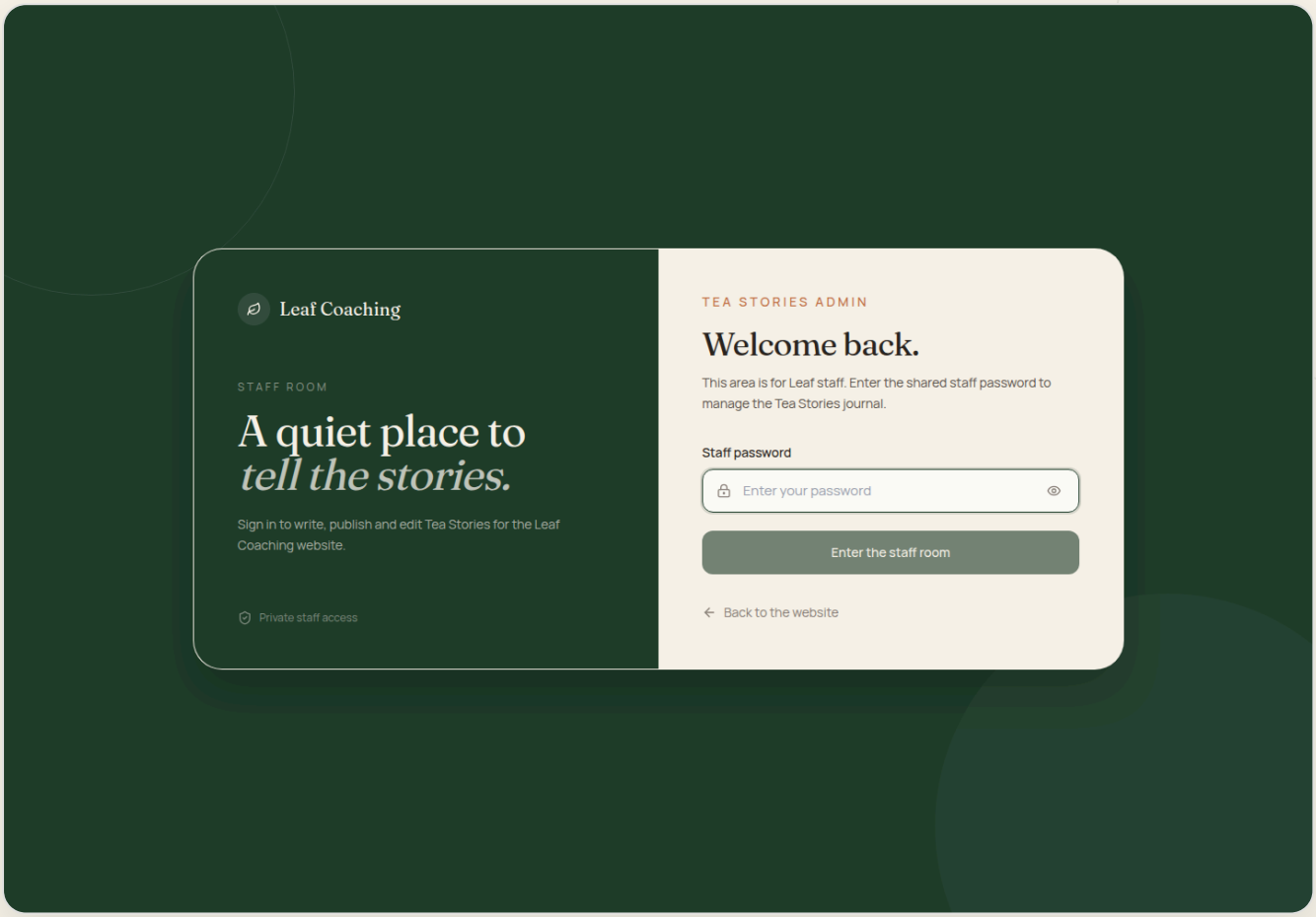
The public address is built from the story's **web address**, for example: `/tea-stories/the-tea-that-tasted-like-home`.

1

STEP ONE

Sign in to the staff room.

The Tea Stories area is private. You need the shared staff password before you can write, edit or publish anything.



1. Open **www.leafcoaching.com/admin/login** in your browser.
2. Type the **shared staff password** into the password field.
3. Click **Enter the staff room**.
4. You should land on **The story desk** at `/admin/tea-stories`.

Access notes

A sign-in lasts for **8 hours** in the same browser. After that you will be asked to sign in again.

If the password is entered incorrectly **6 times in 10 minutes**, the form pauses further attempts. Wait a few minutes before trying again.

Opening `/admin/tea-stories` while signed out simply redirects to the login page.

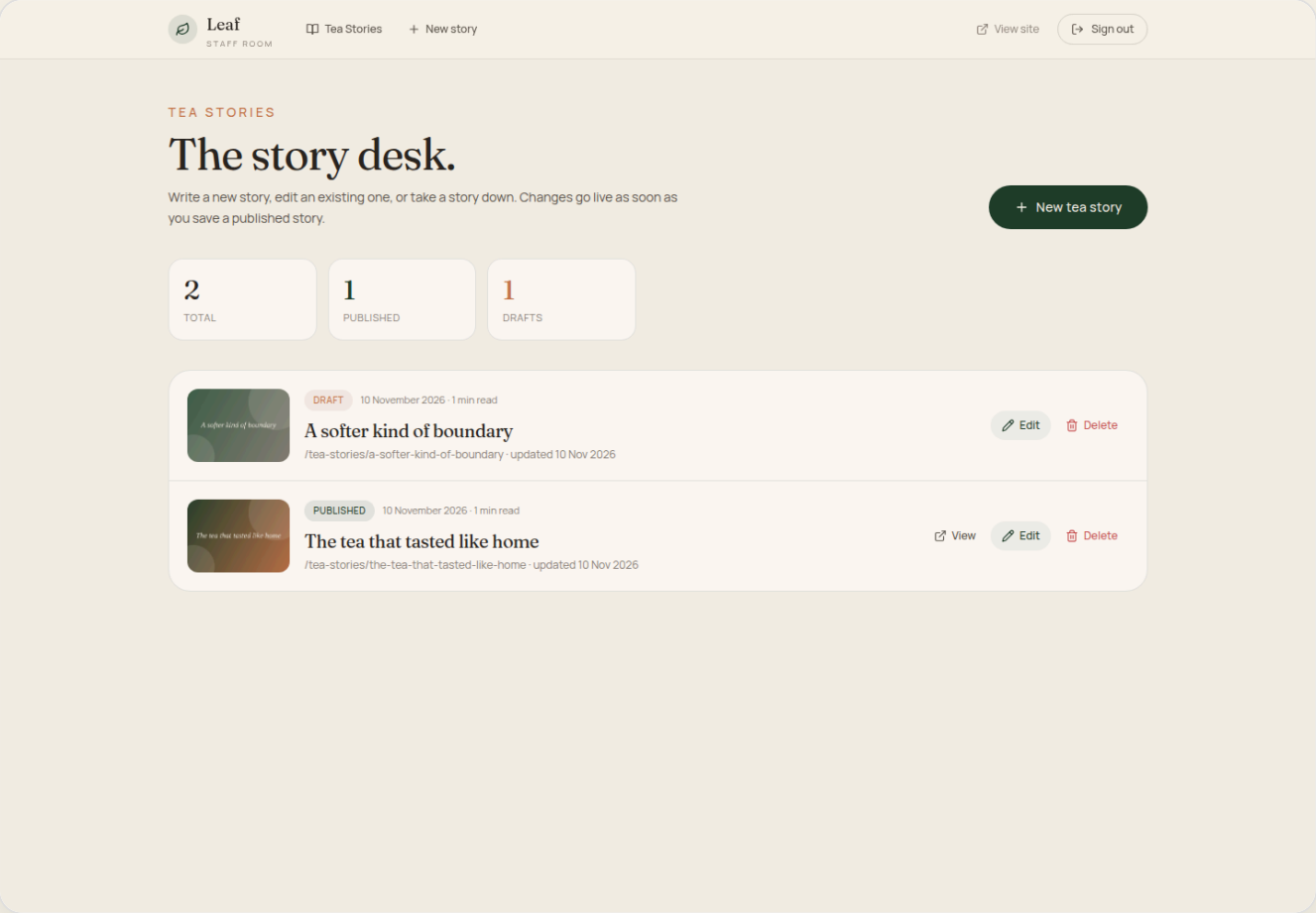
> **IF YOU SEE "LOGIN IS NOT CONFIGURED YET"**
>
> The site is missing its staff-login settings. This is not something staff can fix from the website. Contact the web administrator and send them the exact message shown on screen.

2

STEP TWO

Open the story desk.

After signing in you arrive at **The story desk**. This is the home of every Tea Story — published and draft.



Example shown. Your desk will list your own stories. The counts at the top update automatically.

Start a new story

Click the dark **New tea story** button on the right. The **+ New story** link in the top navigation does the same thing.

Read the badges

Published means the story is live. **Draft** means it is only visible to signed-in staff.

Use the row actions

View opens the public page (published stories only). **Edit** opens the editor. **Delete** removes the story permanently.

OPENING A STORY

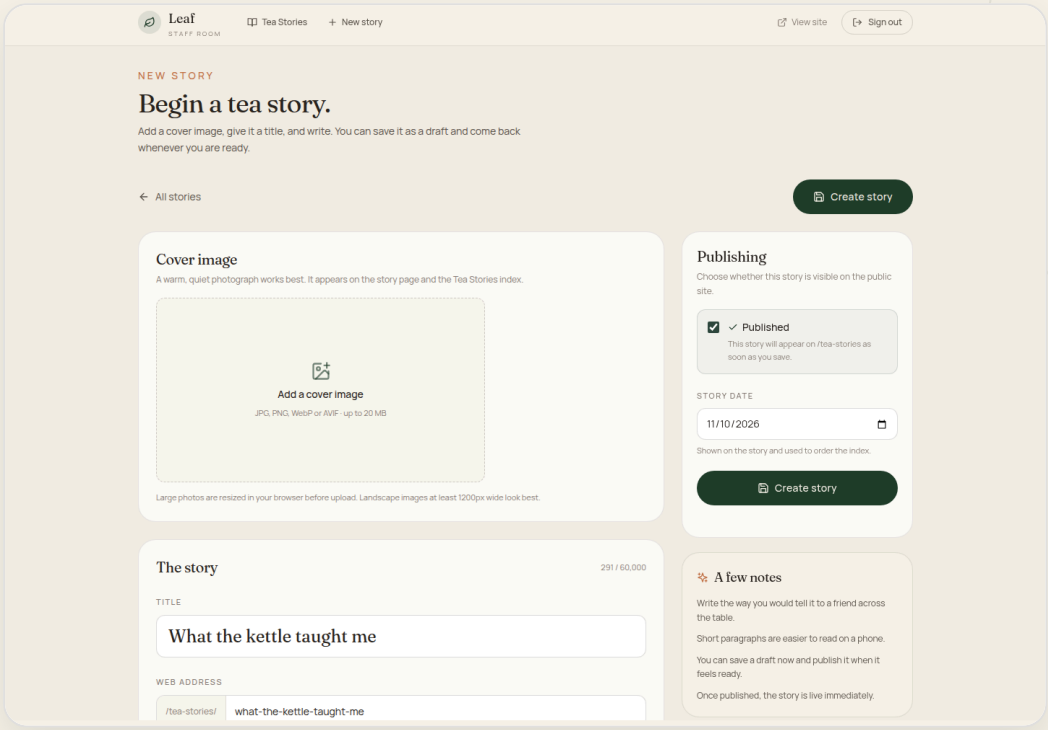
Click **New tea story** to begin. If you are returning to an existing story, find it in the list and click **Edit**.

3

STEP THREE

Add a cover image.

The cover appears on the Tea Stories index and at the top of the story page. It sets the mood before a single word is read.



The new story editor. The cover image area sits at the top left; publishing controls stay visible on the right.

Image rules

- [ ] **Required for a new story.**
- [ ] JPG, PNG, WebP or AVIF. The picker accepts files up to 20 MB.
- [ ] Large photos are resized in the browser; the server accepts a final upload up to 4 MB.
- [ ] Landscape, ideally at least 1200px wide. Keep the subject near the centre — the image is cropped to a wide shape.

Choose and check

1. Click **Add a cover image** and choose the file.
2. Check the preview. If it is wrong, choose **Replace** or **Undo**.
3. A warm, quiet photograph works best. Avoid busy graphics with lots of text.

What makes a good cover?

Choose something that feels like the story, not a generic stock image. A cup on a table, a window, a walk, a hand — ordinary moments usually work better than posed portraits. Keep the subject near the centre, away from the top and bottom edges.

IF THE IMAGE WILL NOT UPLOAD

Export it again as a JPG around 1600px wide. The picker accepts large files, but the final upload must be under 4 MB. If it still fails, send the image and the exact error to the web administrator.

4

STEP FOUR

Write the story.

Start with the title and web address, add an optional introduction, then write the story itself. There is no auto-save, so keep a copy of anything long until you have saved.

FIELD	RULE	WHAT TO DO
Title	2–140 characters	Use the title you want readers to see. It also becomes the web address until you change it.
Web address	Auto-created	Made from the title in lower-case with hyphens. You may edit it, but **old links will stop working**. If the address is already used, the site adds `-2`.
Short introduction	Optional, up to 240 characters	One or two inviting sentences. If left blank, the site uses the opening of the story (about 180 characters).
Story date	Date picker	Shown on the story and used to order the index. The newest date is featured first.

THE MAIN TEXT

20–60,000 CHARACTERS

The Story box.

Simple formatting

TYPE THIS	TO GET
`## A heading`	A section heading
`> A quote`	A large italic quote
`- First point`	A bullet list (one per line)
`**bold**`	**Bold text**
`*italic*`	*Italic text*
`---`	A horizontal divider

How it behaves

- [ ] A blank line starts a new paragraph.
- [ ] Put a blank line before and after a heading, quote or list.
- [ ] The editor does not create clickable links. Keep web addresses as plain text.
- [ ] There is no built-in preview or formatting toolbar — read it through before saving.

WRITING NOTE

Write the way you would tell it to a friend across the table. Short paragraphs are easier to read on a phone.

BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

Read the introduction and the first two paragraphs aloud. If the opening does not invite someone in, rewrite it before publishing — that is the part most readers will see first on the index.

5

STEP FIVE

Choose Published or Draft.

This is the visibility switch. It is the one setting to check twice before you save a new story.

THE ONE SETTING TO GET RIGHT

A new story starts with Published ticked. If you are not ready to go live, untick it. The label changes to **Save as a draft**. Clicking **Create story** with Published ticked puts the story on the public website immediately.

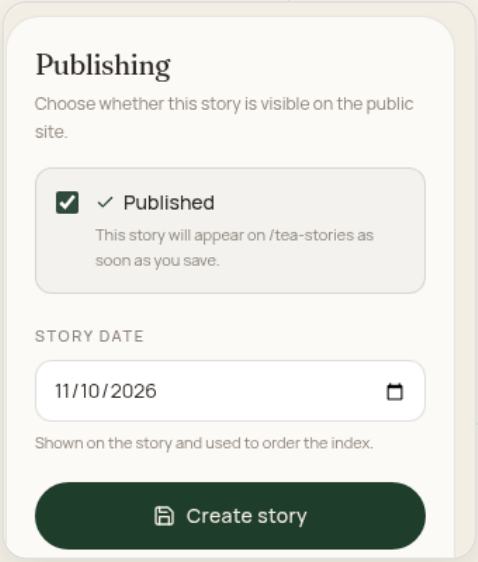
Published

Visible on `/tea-stories` and its own page as soon as you save.

Save as a draft

Only signed-in staff see it on the story desk. Publish it later by ticking the box.

Story date: choose the date readers should see. It also decides the order of the index — the newest date is featured first.



The Publishing panel. A ticked box reads **Published**; an empty box reads **Save as a draft**.

If you are publishing now

- [ ] Cover image added and checked.
- [ ] Title, introduction and date are correct.
- [ ] Story read through for missing words or stray markers.
- [ ] **Published** is ticked.
- [ ] You are ready for the link to be public.

If you are saving a draft

- [ ] **Published** is unticked and the label reads **Save as a draft**.
- [ ] You understand the public page will not exist yet.
- [ ] You know to return to **Edit** to finish and publish.
- [ ] You have kept a copy of any long text.

A DRAFT IS NOT A PRIVATE PREVIEW

A draft is hidden from the public, and there is no separate preview page. Check the text in the editor, then publish and use **View** when you are ready. Do not publish just to "see" it unless you are happy for it to be live.

6

STEP SIX

Create, then check the live page.

Saving takes you back to the story desk. Always open the public page once before you share the link — it is the quickest way to catch a missing image or an unfinished sentence.

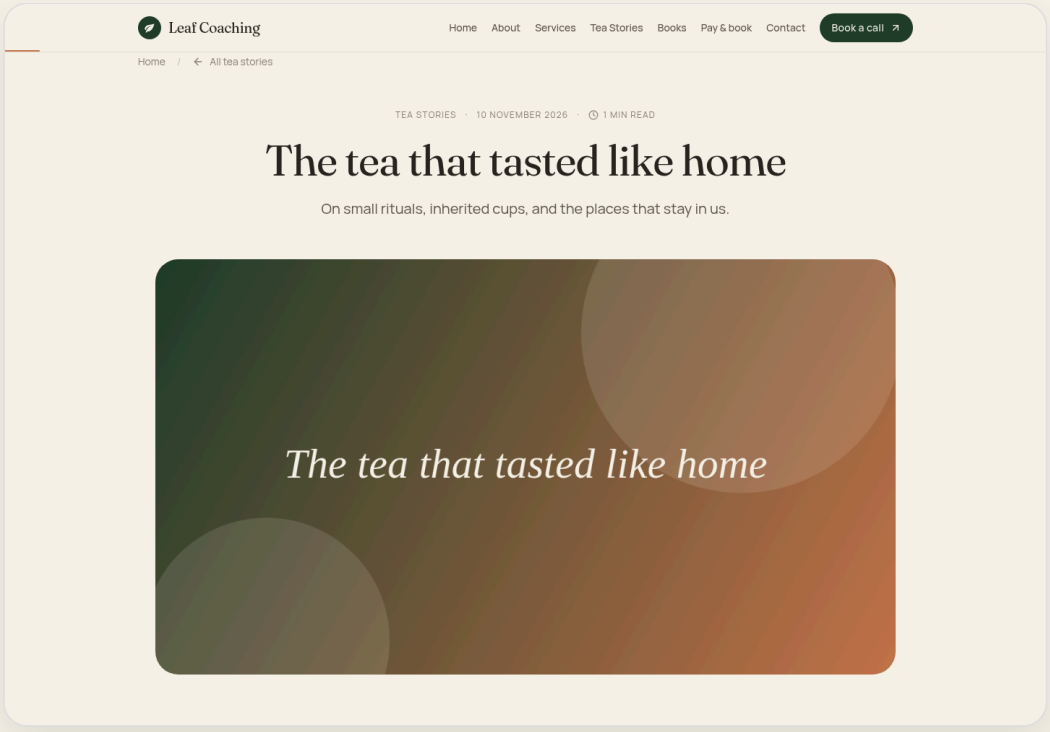
1. Click **Create story** — either at the top right or in the Publishing panel.
2. Wait for the message that the image is uploading and saving. You will then be returned to **The story desk**.
3. Find the story in the list and check the green **Published** badge (or **Draft** if you unticked the box).
4. Click **View** to open the public story page. Read it on both desktop and phone if you can.
5. Open **www.leafcoaching.com/tea-stories** and confirm the story appears in the index.

What good looks like

- [ ] The cover image loads and is not stretched.
- [ ] The title, introduction and date are correct.
- [ ] Paragraphs, headings, quotes and lists render as intended.
- [ ] The page ends cleanly with no stray markers such as `##` or `**`.
- [ ] The public address matches the web address shown in the editor.

IF YOU SAVED A DRAFT

There will be no **View** link, because the public page does not exist yet. Open **Edit**, tick **Published**, and click **Save changes** when you are ready.



Example story page. Check the title, introduction, date, cover and body before sharing the link.

AFTER PUBLISHING

Edit, unpublish or delete.

Everything starts from the story desk. Use **Edit** for changes, **Published** for visibility, and **Delete** only when you mean it.

01 · EDIT

Change the story.

1. On the story desk, click **Edit** beside the story.
2. Change the title, introduction, body, date or cover. Leave the image alone to keep the current one.
3. Click **Save changes**. You return to the story desk.
4. Click **View** to check the public page again.

If the story is published, edits go live as soon as you save.

02 · UNPUBLISH

Take it down temporarily.

1. Click **Edit** beside the story.
2. In the Publishing panel, untick **Published**. The label changes to **Save as a draft**.
3. Click **Save changes**.
4. The story disappears from the public journal. Nothing is deleted.

The public link stops working while it is a draft. Republish by ticking **Published** and saving again.

03 · DELETE

Remove it permanently.

1. On the story desk, click **Delete** beside the story.
2. Read the confirmation. It names the story and warns that the story and its image will be removed.
3. Click **OK** to confirm, or **Cancel** to stop.

This cannot be undone. If you only need a break, unpublish instead.

04 · WEB ADDRESS

Changing the link.

The **Web address** is the last part of the public URL. You can change it in the editor, but the old address does **not** redirect — any link already shared will stop working.

If a story has already been shared, leave the web address alone unless you can update every place it was posted.

If the address is already taken, the site adds `-2`, then `-3`, and so on.

CHOOSE THE GENTLEST OPTION THAT WORKS

Unpublish when a story needs a rest, a correction or a second look. **Delete** only when the story should never return. Deleting also removes its cover image.

TROUBLESHOOTING

If something is not working.

Most problems are one of these. Try the fix first; if the message mentions setup or storage, it needs the web administrator.

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
You are sent back to the login page	Your 8-hour session has ended. Sign in again.
“That password is not correct”	Check Caps Lock and retype the shared password. After **6 wrong attempts in 10 minutes**, wait a few minutes before trying again.
“Too many attempts”	Wait at least 10 minutes, then sign in with the correct password.
“Login is not configured yet”	The staff login settings are missing. Send the exact message to the web administrator.
“Please add a cover image”	A new story cannot be saved without one. Add a JPG, PNG, WebP or AVIF image.
The image is rejected or upload fails	Use JPG, PNG, WebP or AVIF. The picker accepts up to 20 MB and resizes large files, but the final upload must be under 4 MB. If needed, export a smaller JPG around 1600px wide and try again.
Title or story length error	The title must be 2–140 characters. The story must be at least 20 characters and no more than 60,000.
A new story is not on the public journal	Open **Edit** and check that **Published** is ticked, then save. Also confirm the story date and refresh the public page.
A public link now shows “not found”	The story may be a draft, deleted, or its **Web address** was changed. Republish it, or change the web address back to the old one and save.
“Storage is not connected” or “storage is not configured”	The site cannot save stories. This needs the web administrator — do not keep retrying.

Final check before you close the tab

- [ ] Cover image loads and looks right.
- [ ] Title, introduction and date are correct.
- [ ] Story reads cleanly with no stray `##` or `**`.
- [ ] Published or Draft is the status you intended.
- [ ] Public page has been opened with **View**.
- [ ] The link has been copied if it is being shared.

NEED HELP?

Send the web administrator a useful message.

Include the page you were on, the story title, what you expected, what happened, and a screenshot of any error. That is enough to investigate without guessing.

STAFF ENTRANCE

www.leafcoaching.com/admin/login